

Political Strategy Report: Independent African American Political Power

Executive Summary

The political strategy is built around a central proposition: **African American political interests should not be permanently subordinated to either the Democratic or Republican Party.**

The objective is not ideological conversion to the political left or right. The objective is the acquisition and preservation of sufficient independent African American political power to compel political institutions, candidates, and coalitions to respect African American civil rights, human rights, community interests, and institutional autonomy.

The strategy treats political parties as instruments rather than identities. Support is conditional, alliances are temporary when necessary, and political resources should be directed toward whichever available channel produces the greatest progress toward the underlying mission.

Rather than relying upon a single electoral tactic, the strategy maintains multiple simultaneous lines of effort. Attention and resources are shifted among them according to changing political conditions. Blocked avenues are maintained where useful but are not allowed to consume resources that could generate greater returns elsewhere.

The operating principle is therefore:

Fixed mission. Multiple active strategies. Continuous assessment. Concentrated effort where political opportunity is greatest.

I. Strategic Mission

The primary mission is to increase the independent political power of African Americans, particularly marginalized African American communities.

This mission is not inherently Democratic, Republican, liberal, or conservative.

Political ideology is subordinate to several fundamental requirements:

- equal citizenship;
- equal protection under law;
- protection against racial discrimination;
- physical and community security;
- meaningful voting rights;
- economic opportunity;

- institutional representation;
- political self-determination;
- access to education, capital, employment, and public institutions;
- the ability of African American communities to organize independently in defense of their interests.

Political actors may disagree about taxation, regulation, religion, foreign policy, social policy, or the proper size of government while remaining bound by these minimum standards.

Civil and human rights therefore operate as **preconditions for legitimate political competition rather than ordinary partisan bargaining chips.**

II. Rejection of Permanent Partisan Dependency

The strategy rejects the assumption that African Americans must permanently belong to the Democratic Party because the Republican Party is perceived as worse.

Historically, many African American voters have approached presidential elections as a choice of the **lesser of two evils rather than the better of two goods.**

Under these conditions, Democratic political dominance among Black voters does not necessarily indicate satisfaction with Democratic representation.

Instead, it can produce electoral capture.

The cycle operates approximately as follows:

Republican hostility or perceived hostility

→ **African American consolidation behind Democrats**

→ **Democratic confidence that Black voters have nowhere else to go**

→ **reduced bargaining leverage for Black constituencies**

→ **dissatisfaction with Democratic performance**

→ **continued Democratic voting because Republicans remain unacceptable.**

The result is electoral participation without corresponding political independence.

The strategy seeks to break this cycle.

III. Independent Political Capacity

The long-term answer to electoral capture is the development of political institutions that do not depend upon either major party for their existence.

The Malone Party is conceived as one potential vehicle for that independence.

Its function would not simply be to compete with Democrats and Republicans for symbolic purposes. Its purpose would be to create an autonomous center of political power capable of:

- developing candidates;
- organizing voters;
- defining policy priorities;
- establishing ethical standards;
- conducting public accountability;
- negotiating with larger parties;
- endorsing or opposing candidates;
- withdrawing support;
- mobilizing communities;
- building political leadership;
- applying pressure across party boundaries.

Political independence creates bargaining power because neither major party can assume automatic support.

The ultimate goal is not necessarily the destruction of the existing parties. It is the destruction of **political dependency**.

IV. Multi-Vector Political Pressure

The strategy does not depend upon a single method.

Multiple political pressures operate simultaneously.

Potential lines of effort include:

Independent institution-building.

Develop political organizations capable of operating outside the Democratic-Republican structure.

Pressure on Democrats.

Challenge Democratic politicians who expect African American support without providing adequate representation or measurable results.

Pressure within Republican institutions.

Encourage circumstances in which Republican organizations must directly confront racial exclusion, discrimination, extremism, and minority demands within their own coalition.

Candidate development.

Build a class of political actors capable of representing community interests rather than merely advancing within existing party hierarchies.

Public accountability.

Force candidates and institutions to answer difficult ethical and policy questions publicly.

Electoral independence.

Make support contingent upon performance rather than inherited party loyalty.

Coalition formation.

Work with politically different constituencies when interests overlap without surrendering independent objectives.

Community organization.

Build political influence from the local level upward rather than relying exclusively upon national personalities.

These lines of effort reinforce one another.

Independent organization can increase leverage over Democrats.

Republican minority participation can pressure Republican institutions to restrain discriminatory behavior.

Democratic complacency can strengthen demand for independent political organizations.

Public accountability can increase the effectiveness of every other strategy.

The strategy is therefore a **political system rather than a single campaign**.

V. Open-Lane Resource Allocation

The strategy should not be described as continuously “pivoting.”

A pivot implies abandoning one direction for another.

Instead, numerous strategies remain active simultaneously.

The appropriate metaphor is **spinning multiple plates** or directing traffic through multiple political lanes.

Some lanes become congested.

Others temporarily open.

Some strategies require maintenance but little active intervention.

Others suddenly become highly productive because political circumstances have changed.

Leadership therefore continuously asks:

Where will the next unit of effort produce the greatest advancement toward the fixed mission?

Resources can then be concentrated accordingly.

The process is:

maintain multiple viable lines of effort

→ **observe changing conditions**

→ **identify open political lanes**

→ **increase effort where returns are highest**

→ **reduce investment in blocked lanes**

→ **preserve blocked options where future conditions may reopen them**

→ **reallocate again as conditions change.**

This preserves strategic optionality while preventing mission drift.

VI. Fixed Principles, Flexible Methods

Political flexibility must not become political opportunism.

The strategy therefore distinguishes between **immutable objectives and adaptable methods**.

Tactics may change.

Coalitions may change.

Candidates may change.

Political parties may change.

Messaging may change.

Priorities among active campaigns may change.

The fundamental mission does not.

This distinction separates strategic flexibility from the political behavior of personalities who simply move wherever public attention or personal advantage appears strongest.

The governing rule is:

Methods serve principles; principles do not change merely to preserve access to power.

VII. Republican Institutional Transformation

A significant component of the strategy concerns the internal consequences of growing minority participation within Republican institutions.

The theory is not that every African American Republican is consciously attempting to transform the Republican Party.

Rather, meaningful minority participation can create institutional pressure regardless of individual motivation.

A historically homogeneous political organization may permit rhetoric or behavior that becomes increasingly costly once African Americans acquire membership, votes, offices, donor relationships, leadership positions, and organizational authority within it.

The progression may resemble:

minority presence

→ **increased social restraint**

→ **political dependency**

→ **bargaining leverage**

→ **institutional authority**

→ **transformation of organizational norms.**

Initially, hostile individuals may merely become more cautious.

They may refrain from discriminatory behavior because African American members are present.

Later, discriminatory behavior may become politically costly because it threatens votes, candidates, donors, coalitions, or organizational credibility.

Eventually, conduct previously tolerated may become incompatible with continued membership or leadership.

The significance is that institutional behavior can change before private attitudes change.

VIII. The Pyrrhic Victory Problem

This produces a strategic contradiction for political factions that seek both electoral expansion and continued racial dominance.

Such a faction may want simultaneously to:

1. win elections;
2. expand minority support;
3. preserve existing internal power relationships;
4. retain political cultures based upon racial exclusion.

These objectives may eventually become incompatible.

If minority voters become necessary to political victory, their participation eventually extends beyond voting.

Voters become organizers.

Organizers become delegates.

Delegates become candidates.

Candidates become officeholders.

Officeholders acquire budgets, appointments, endorsements, staff, donor relationships, and policymaking authority.

At that point, continued electoral success may require meaningful power-sharing.

From the perspective of a faction committed to racial dominance, this can become a **Pyrrhic victory**.

The party survives.

It may continue winning elections.

Yet survival requires abandoning portions of the racial hierarchy that previously defined its internal culture.

The institution remains, but it becomes increasingly unrecognizable to the faction that once expected to dominate it.

IX. Grassroots Institutional Pressure

Bottom-up participation may be particularly important.

National political rhetoric can remain abstract.

Local politics forces direct interaction.

At the precinct, county, campaign, committee, and community level, people who might otherwise regard one another as hostile abstractions must work together.

A person inclined toward racial discrimination may suddenly have to consider:

Can I say this while this member is sitting beside me?

Then:

Can I behave this way when that member controls votes?

Later:

Can the organization afford this behavior if it damages minority recruitment?

Eventually:

Does someone who repeatedly behaves this way belong in the organization at all?

The progression moves from politeness imposed by circumstance toward genuine institutional constraint.

Even compelled restraint represents a shift in power.

Someone who once possessed unilateral freedom to demean another constituency must begin calculating the political consequences of doing so.

The targeted constituency has acquired the ability to impose costs.

Repeated across thousands of local interactions, this can become structural.

X. Tokenism Versus Political Power

Minority presence alone does not constitute representation.

The relevant question is whether minority participants possess independent authority.

A token demonstrates diversity.

A politically empowered representative possesses resources that other political actors must negotiate with.

Those resources may include:

- voters;
- money;

- offices;
- membership;
- organizational leadership;
- media audiences;
- donor networks;
- community relationships;
- endorsements;
- institutional legitimacy.

The transition from tokenism to power occurs when the relationship changes from:

“You are permitted to participate.”

to:

“The institution cannot succeed without negotiating with you.”

Political dependency creates bargaining power.

XI. Political Accountability as a Weapon of Legitimacy

Another component of the strategy is disciplined public questioning.

Political candidates routinely rely upon slogans, ideological labels, partisan loyalty, and carefully managed messaging.

Ethical questioning can force them beyond these protections.

Questions can expose contradictions between declared principles and actual conduct.

Examples include:

You claim equal citizenship. Does this policy provide equal treatment?

You condemn discrimination. What consequence follows when members of your coalition engage in it?

You request African American votes. What institutional authority will African American constituents actually receive?

You claim to represent marginalized communities. What happens when their interests conflict with powerful donors or established constituencies?

The objective is not embarrassment for its own sake.

The objective is to establish standards politicians cannot evade without reputational cost.

When candidates refuse to answer legitimate questions, provide contradictory responses, or violate their own stated principles, reputational damage becomes an enforcement mechanism.

The political advantage comes from controlling the **standard of accountability**, not merely from winning rhetorical exchanges.

XII. Planned Campaigns and Mission Discipline

Organic political change has advantages because it can emerge without centralized planning and may survive individual leadership changes.

However, deliberately organized campaigns can potentially achieve more focused results because they possess:

- defined objectives;
- target conditions;
- measurable outcomes;
- leadership;
- coordination;
- mission discipline;
- planned allocation of resources.

Their weakness is brittleness.

Poor leadership, exposure of improper conduct, internal disagreement, mission drift, or strategic miscalculation can destroy a highly coordinated campaign more quickly than an organic social movement.

Accordingly, deliberate political intervention should remain within legitimate democratic mechanisms such as organizing, candidate recruitment, persuasion, public advocacy, coalition-building, elections, institutional participation, and public accountability.

The strategic objective is not clandestine control of political organizations.

It is the deliberate creation of political conditions under which hostile factions lose influence and equal participation becomes institutionally necessary.

XIII. Bipartisan Human-Rights Floor

The strategy ultimately seeks to make certain standards nonpartisan.

African American civil and human rights should not depend upon which party controls government.

A conservative and progressive may disagree extensively while still recognizing that:

- racial discrimination is unacceptable;
- racial violence is unacceptable;
- unequal citizenship is unacceptable;
- exclusion from political participation is unacceptable;
- government institutions must provide equal protection;
- marginalized communities have the right to organize for political power.

Under this model, hostility toward these principles becomes disqualifying regardless of party affiliation.

The strategic contest therefore shifts from:

Democrat versus Republican

toward:

legitimate democratic competition versus political behavior incompatible with equal citizenship.

XIV. Coalition Power Rather Than Ideological Purity

The strategy views modern American politics increasingly as competition over **coalition ownership and institutional control**.

Political actors may possess overlapping identities and contradictory policy preferences.

The essential strategic questions become:

Who controls the institution?

Which constituency provides the votes necessary for survival?

Who controls candidates and leadership pipelines?

Who can impose political costs?

Who can withdraw support?

Whose interests must be negotiated rather than merely acknowledged?

Under this framework, political allegiance is not equivalent to political power.

A constituency can vote overwhelmingly for one party while possessing limited leverage over it.

Conversely, a relatively small constituency can acquire disproportionate influence if its support becomes necessary to maintain a governing coalition.

The purpose of independent political organization is therefore to convert African American population, votes, institutions, economic resources, leadership, and community networks into **negotiable political power**.

XV. Strategic End State

The desired end state is not necessarily one-party dominance.

It is a competitive political environment in which no major political institution can safely:

- disregard African American concerns;
- assume unconditional African American support;
- tolerate openly discriminatory factions without consequence;
- use minority representatives merely as political symbols;
- deny meaningful minority institutional authority while requesting minority votes.

Instead, political organizations would have to compete for African American support through measurable performance.

African American communities would possess independent organizations capable of rewarding cooperation, punishing hostility, developing their own leadership, and withdrawing support when commitments are violated.

Under these conditions, political parties would no longer determine African American political identity.

African American political institutions would determine **whether, when, and under what conditions those parties receive African American cooperation**.

Conclusion

The political strategy can be summarized as **independent power through strategic multiplicity**.

Its central principles are:

The mission remains fixed.

Political parties are instruments, not identities.

No party receives permanent allegiance.

Multiple strategies operate simultaneously.

Resources flow toward open political lanes.

Blocked approaches are maintained when future utility remains possible.

Minority representation must become institutional power rather than symbolism.

Public accountability imposes reputational costs for misconduct.
Civil and human rights establish the minimum bipartisan standard.
Political flexibility applies to methods, never to the fundamental mission.

The ultimate objective is not simply greater African American participation within existing political structures.

It is to create enough independent political capacity that **African American communities become a constituency that political institutions must negotiate with rather than a constituency either party can take for granted.**